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To: [REDACTED]
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On this particular day back in 2002 I was stationed aboard the USCGC Sassafras, which was a 180 foot Buoy Tender whose port was the ComNavMar Naval Station on the Island of Guam. I recall that we had been stuck in port for the previous couple of weeks prior due to the fact that we constantly had trouble with equipment breaking and at least one of our ship's two generators always seemed to have something wrong at any given time and the Cutter wasn't considered fit for Sea Service unless both of the generators were fully working and able to operate at full capacity. This was a common problem that seemed to always plague us as we had so many different trips to various local Islands in Micronesia that we had to cancel during my tour of duty there due to the fact that we constantly had equipment breaking down. The boat was just so old and outdated and was very close to finally being decommissioned the following year and replaced by the USCGC Sequoia which was a newer class of 225 ft Buoy Tenders that ended up replacing all of the older class of 180 ft Buoy Tenders. I bring up these specific details to lead up to the fact that I recall we always had a monthly quota we had to meet of doing a certain number of drills, i.e. fire drills, man overboard drills, General Quarters (Which meant man your battle stations) and regular SAR training (Search and Rescue.) The particular day of this incident was an extremely busy and stressful day for all of the crew because none of us enjoyed these long days of going underway and just doing constant drills for hours upon hours and getting knocked around by the harsh sea conditions and rough waters we always seemed to encounter as soon as we left the harbor. There was a whole lot of yelling and screaming and of course it was very physically demanding having to deal with the extremely heavy fire hoses and of course the fact that we had two teams of people assigned to work with the Gunner's Mates in quickly retrieving our ship's main two weapons which were two mounted 50 Caliber Machine Guns which we would mount on the bow of the ship. We had one gun for port side and the other was on the starboard side directly opposite each other and everything had to be carried up the ladders and hoisted by hand with ropes as we didn't have hydraulic lifts to help with such tasks like most more modern ships would.

On the particular day I'm writing about, I recall we started off with our usual routine of doing Morning Muster at approximately 0715 and we had set sailing orders for around 0800 and we already knew well ahead of time that it was going to be a very long and stressful day and we knew it had been a while since we were fit to go to sea so we knew what we were in for. A long afternoon full of drills and training. These were definitely the most stressful of days and I believe everyone dreaded setting sail for these day trips just for the purpose of doing drills cause we could count on being yelled and screamed at and constantly having to rush everywhere and follow certain set procedures and I'm going to skip to later on in the afternoon, after we had just conducted what was supposed to be our last drill for the day, it was a General Quarters drill and we had just stood down and disassembled the 50 Cals and stowed them back in the ship's Armory and I believe they were working on charting our exact course back to Apra Harbor.

This was late afternoon but it was still full daylight out and I'm wanting to guess we couldn't have been more than 20 miles off shore. I recall that we would normally head due South whenever we would go underway for purposes of doing drills and training. The water seemed to have calmed down a bit and wasn't quite as choppy as it was when our day had first started and I recall that there was really good visibility and at the time this next sequence of events unfolded, there was only one visible contact that I remember seeing which was probably about a mile or so in the distance. I would soon discover that contact that was observed turned out to be a Taiwanese fishing vessel of some kind and this is where life as I know it changed...

All I know is apparently our Captain, LCDR Corson was the acting OOD (Officer of the Deck) said that he personally took a call on the radio from a Marine Helicopter that did appear shortly afterwards and all of a sudden we went from getting ready to head back to shore to yet, another alarm sounding. This time it was another General Quarters, only this time specifically stands out in my mind because it was the one and only time in my career that I heard the words "This is not a drill, I repeat, this is not a drill!" piped over the intercom right after the initial alarm sounded. So back to our battle stations we went and awaited further instruction.

At the time of this incident, I was a E-3 (Fireman) and I worked in the Auxillary Engineering unit (also known as A Gang.) There were two different teams of us who worked in the Engineering Department, we had Main Prop and A Gang. Main Prop was responsible for all maintenance, repairs and upkeep of the ship's two Main Detroit Diesel Engines

as well as the two Diesel Generators that supplied all of our ship's power when we weren't plugged into the shore station. And my team in A Gang was responsible for everything else from the Reverse Osmosis Water Purification system, the ships reefers and refrigeration, sewage, and of course the ship's large Boom which we normally used to lift extremely heavy Buoys out of the water, as well as section by section we would lift the huge chain that was attached at the bottom to a huge concrete block which acts as the anchor that holds each buoy in place. Whenever we used the boom, we had a third Diesel generator that we would run specifically for the purpose of powering the large boom. That third, smaller generator was also the ship's emergency backup power source but was only capable of powering the ship's reefers and refrigeration units as well as the large hydraulic rudder in the AFT section. Of course during heavy winds and Typhoons and rough seas these buoys often get knocked around and out of alignment so that's where our ship's boom came into play, we were responsible for the maintenance and upkeep of all of the island's buoys and Channel markers as well as a lot of the other local Islands of Micronesia like Saipan, Yap, Tinian, Rota, and Kwajalein Atoll.

Our CO received a call over the radio about what was believed to be some kind of unknown enemy vehicle or weapon that was in very close proximity to our location at the time so that's why we were dispatched and were first to arrive on the scene of what happened next. The last thing I remember is being out on the ship's main deck and chilling out and smoking a cigarette talking with a buddy. That's when the final alarm sounded which turned out to be the real thing and not a drill, so as per my job at that time, I proceeded to the Engine Room as was my designated assignment for GQ situations. Because of the loud noise from all of the engines and different machinery we all had to wear giant noise cancelling headsets with microphones to keep in constant contact with each other and with the Bridge. During General Quarters my main job was to simply head to the Engine room and await further instruction.

I remember during the first few minutes of going to my assigned area in the Engine room it became apparent that two of our headsets were not working properly and we ended up having absolutely no communication with the bridge. Therefore I was chosen to be the messenger running back and forth between Engine room and Bridge. Although as soon as I left the engine room and went up on the Bridge, I remained there for probably a good 10 minutes or so as we were steering closer and closer to the fishing vessel that I had spotted minutes before and I could see there was a lot of commotion on their decks and I got a first very clear glimpse of a fairly large metallic looking object that appeared to be tangled in their fishing net and I think I momentarily blacked out as I was so stunned by what we were witnessing in the water as was everyone else on the Bridge. In fact I was so transfixed on the object that was within probably 150 yards of us that I wasn't paying attention to anything that was being said around me. Although I remember hearing the order to stand down from General Quarters and for everyone to quickly get inside the ship and that absolutely nobody was to go outside for any reason whatsoever until we received further instructions. And I remember them quickly assembling a few officers that were part of our boarding team and we were to launch one of our two small boats to get a closer look at this object and what was going on. I was told by one of the Officers on the bridge to relay this information to the Engine Room and I immediately reported back to Chief Falcone. He was in charge of A Gang and was also the EOD (Engineer of the Deck) on that particular day. He was of course completely dumbfounded and I was near hysterical in trying to explain to him what I had just witnessed while on the Bridge and that no matter what, everyone was supposed to stay inside and not go out on the decks for any reason. No smoking, no fresh air, nada. That's the only time in my career in the Coast Guard I had ever heard of the entire crew being ordered to stay inside except in the rare cases of extremely rough seas during powerful storms. I then remember one of our other officers, LTJG Jarnett appearing wearing his boarding gear and strapped with our standard issue 9 mm pistol. He asked my Chief for a Geiger counter (To check for radiation) and my Chief ran off with him for a couple minutes and apparently retrieved it and then I witnessed him and about 3 other officers in full boarding gear leave to go topside, obviously to one of our small boats. About this time we sat down for a minute in the ship's mess hall and noticed a junior Officer, Ensign Pequignot (Not sure if I spelled that correctly) covering all of the portholes and windows with cardboard and masking tape, which he then ran out of and switched to using Duct tape to completely cover each and every porthole and block everyone's view of what was going on outside. As that was happening I remember seeing the Orange color of the ship's RHIB (Rigid Hull Inflatable) small boat with about 4 people on board, so they had quickly already lowered and deployed that in a matter of minutes and it was total chaos amongst my fellow shipmates as we were all confused and most people started getting very angry and frustrated for the lack of information and all of the secrecy that even our most trusted, top notch Chiefs and Engineers were being kept completely in the dark. The Officer covering all of windows kept getting questions asked and he just kept replying "Sorry, Captain's orders, I don't know anymore than you guys do," or something along those lines. By that time, word of the strange metallic object in the water had already gotten out and spread like wildfire as during that General Quarters alarm, there were quite a few crew members whose jobs were to be with the gunners up on the front Bow of the ship and they all at least got to catch a glimpse of the metallic object next to the fishing vessel. Although at that point in time, none of us had really gotten a good enough look at it to be able to tell its exact shape or dimensions, just that it was something rather large, metallic looking and very out of place!

I'm a little fuzzy on the exact order and sequence of all of the events that follow, but I do remember our chief getting the order to fire up our Emergency generator (that also was run during buoy tending operations where we used our large Boom to do heavy lifting.) Shortly after we turned it on, I remember hearing my name and one other crew member, who

was QM3 (QuarterMaster 3rd class) Belisle to report topside to the bridge. So we both found each other around the mess hall area and proceeded together to the bridge. We both looked at each other but didn't say a word because the atmosphere in that ship was like nothing words will ever be able to come close to describing. We were all nervous and just lost. Upon reaching the bridge, we were immediately greeted by our Captain who we both promptly saluted and were then told to be at ease. We were then addressed directly by the CO himself which seemed rather unusual, especially considering what he told us. He said that whatever happens next is to be treated as "above top secret," were his exact words he used at one point and he said that we were to speak of this to absolutely nobody, including our fellow shipmates, wives, nor friends, just nobody period and that if any of the crew members insisted or bugged us that we were refer them directly to him with their questions and many inquiries that were sure to follow. By this time I could see in the water down below us a pretty large disk shaped metallic object and I saw two of our fellow crew members down on the RHIB still within about 5 feet of the object and I remember seeing one of our officers on board the Taiwanese fishing vessel and I noticed a lot of what appeared to be arguing and frustrated hand gestures. Their boat was still moving and I remember frantic calls on the radio, our CO was I believe talking to our Telecommunications Officer in the radio room right below the bridge to try and get the other vessel to completely stop which for whatever reason, they were not complying. I believe there was some problems with the language barrier and that nobody on board that vessel spoke English so we were having to go through a 3rd party I believe for communications because I don't think anybody on board our ship knew how to speak Mandarin. My perception of time is a bit distorted concerning this series of events but I remember it seemed to take at least a good 20 minutes or so before we finally got the fishing vessel to come to a complete stop and that's when me and a few other crew members were told to follow the Captain down to the ship's main Deck and we immediately had to get the boom ready and were told that whatever this object was, that we had orders to retrieve it and were going to attempt to lift it out of the water. As soon as I heard this I immediately had my doubts that this was even possible, as it appeared from above at least that this object was probably extremely heavy and I myself was part of the crew that routinely had to repair the damn thing almost every single time we used it for buoy tending purposes. It had gotten so bad, we were at the point where it would constantly leak Hydraulic fluid, and these leaks would get worse every single time we used it for lifting buoys and we actually used JB Weld for a good bit of our repairs. And that's all that was running through my mind when the reality of lifting such an enormous object hit me was that this thing was going to break us, I mean this object was probably at least a good 20 or 25 feet in a giant circular shape from what I could see at that point. Yet amazingly, it somehow did show some buoyancy and it did seem to be floating, I don't believe that their fishing net is what had lifted it to the surface of the water. Yet I still have absolutely no clue how it came to be stuck in their net. However I'm going to skip to the part where we ended up lifting it up and away from their fishing net. I learned that it was not in any way tangled up, it was actually really easy to free from the clutches of their net, and we ended up using these mesh ladders, I recognized them as the ladders we would throw over the side of the deck for us to climb back in the ship from the water whenever we would do a swim call when we were underway. Because this metallic craft was completely smooth, it didn't have anywhere on it where we could simply hook it to our boom like we would a buoy and this was the interesting but most time consuming and difficult part of the retrieval. My actual job during this whole time was to hold the rope that was attached to the large, steel hook that swung from the end of the main steel cable hanging from the boom itself. Due to the constant rolling of the ship while underway it was important we always kept that hook secured to something. Otherwise, it would swing erratically and was very hazardous and a constant danger to anyone standing out on the deck.

So while the other crew members were working from both the RHIB which was directly across from the metallic craft and from the Port side of our ship's main deck, I just had to stand there and hold the rope securing the dangling hook as we already had fired up the boom and were awaiting further instructions. I watched very closely as they worked to maneuver those mesh ladders underneath this large object and it did take a good 25 minutes in total I am guessing before I was finally told to prepare to hook the load onto our boom. For this, they simply moved the boom over towards the side of our ship and therefore I was given enough slack to be able to toss the rope over to the guys on the small boat and they then hauled the hook towards them and were able to somehow tie some kind of enormous and odd looking knot together so that the mesh ladders were fully secured and seemed to be wrapped around the object in an ideal manner that would enable us to lift it out of the water. And so that we did. Very slowly of course, and I will add that at this time our XO had assumed control of the bridge and the boom as well (as far as I know cause our CO was outside on the decks down below near me) The very first thing I remember was we had to attempt to lift it directly up and completely out of the water which as soon as we completely had it out of the water and up into the air, it immediately became apparent that this thing had to have been at least twice as heavy as anything I had ever seen it lift before (Including the Larger class of Buoys whose enormous size put them at approximately 18,000 pounds.) Anyways our ship was then listing extremely far towards port side at at least a 45 degree angle. We had no trouble then slowly swinging the object directly over our ship's main deck and then we carefully began the process of trying to lower the object to a complete rest on top of the 4 huge concrete blocks we had situated on our main deck to help maintain balance. Depending on our cargo and the overall ship's weight, we usually either had 3 or 4 of these large concrete blocks for weight and balance purposes and that was assessed ahead of time before each trip we made underway. On this particular day I recall there was all four of the blocks and this was actually very convenient for us because this is how we manage to kind of hold the object in place was to prop it up in a manner that allowed it to actually somehow fit firmly into place and it took a bit of work amongst the

whole group of us at one point pushing with all of our weight and everything in our power get it to lower at just the right spot to try and make it as even and centered as possible for the ride back to the Harbor. But the most interesting part of this happened the moment we first lowered it we had one end of it slightly resting on the surface of the deck but the rest of it was still lifted up and this is where we had to actually make physical contact with the object for the first time (as far I know, it's possible one of the officers on the small boat might have initially touched it at some earlier point.) All I know is that we were warned that this object was giving off a radioactive signature and we were advised at first not to touch it at all if possible. Even so, we all had on regular work gloves. I don't exactly know why, but for whatever reason at the time, I was the first to remove my gloves and I remember touching this object and immediately being scolded by Ensign Ryan for disobeying orders, however the Captain quickly intervened and told him that it is OK.

What followed then was about three other officers also removed their gloves and we all started feeling this object with our bare hands and just trying to figure out not just what the hell it was, but what exactly was this metal that it was made from. It was a dull silver color and it was just so perfectly smooth and just perfect in every aspect as far as just how flawless it seemed to be. At this point, I watched one of the officers pick up a broken piece off one of the concrete blocks that the object was now resting on and he tried to scratch it against this object's surface and he made the comment that whatever this material was, that it seemed to be impervious to any scratches or anything! Almost like it was invincible. I myself noticed him doing all of this so I also ended up picking up a small piece of concrete and I also witnessed this phenomena for myself. No matter how many times I tried banging the rock against it or scratching it really hard, it still remained just so perfect and flawless, it was totally scratch resistant! I think we all took about 5-7 minutes of just saying fuck it and banging on this object and trying to scratch it or find a chink somewhere in its armor because we just wanted to know what the hell this thing was and especially what it was made of! I remember during these few minutes of us just playing around with this object that I overheard all kinds of comments the others were making. And then that's when I heard one of them mention that this metal that the object was made of didn't give off any type of reflection whatsoever. And another officer agreed with him and that is what seemed to amaze them more than anything else about it. I was more mesmerized by the fact that this thing was just so perfect and seemed to be just one giant hunk of impenetrable armor that was completely resistant to even the tiniest scratch or dent!

I cannot say that I saw with my own eyes the fact that the others were claiming that this object didn't show any type of reflective properties like a mirror does, but I did certainly notice that it didn't seem to give off any type of reflection whatsoever from the bright sunlight at first when we came upon it. We still never were able to agree upon what kind of metal this object was most likely made of. I can only say for absolute certainty that it was a dull, silverish color and it was hollow, at least to a certain extent. I remember pounding on it (as did several others) with the side of my fist and it did give off a very deep thud sound so that showed me that this object wasn't completely solid. Also, there was absolutely no markings of any kind on it nor were there any types of seams or possible openings like for a door or window. That is what is still extremely weird to me to this day.

I will say that from my very first few months of being stationed aboard that Coast Guard Cutter, it immediately became clear that there were a lot of strange UFO sightings that would frequently occur while we were underway. And I can also say for sure, that myself as well as many of the other crew members had previously witnessed this EXACT same type of object flying or hovering in the skies above us. But I remember specifically on two separate occasions in the months prior to this, I witnessed this exact craft (at least as far as the shape and size) zipping around at ridiculously fast speeds but I definitely saw it had lights emanating from it on two specific sightings, yet once I actually saw this craft we recovered from the water up close, there certainly weren't any visible lights on it and it wasn't making any type of noise either like machinery running. But the similar disk shaped flying objects I had witnessed on several occasions prior to this recovery process never made any type of sounds either, but they were also never any closer than say a half a mile away at the closest either, so that could account for the lack of any engine noises on all of the previous sightings I recall having of this exact same type of object flying through the beautiful Pacific skies.

So by the time we finally had this object secured in place on the ship's main deck, our next task was to completely cover it with a bunch of blue tarps that we had an abundance of on board and that was a very tedious and time consuming process that involved a whole lot of team work and we ended up having to climb around all over this thing, and at one point, we even had two officers hooked into safety harnesses that were attached to the boom and they were lifted up a few feet into the air just to be able to help with covering the object with the tarps and firmly tying all of those down into place. At this point, I began to notice a submerged submarine not even 50 yards away that appeared to just be observing us.

Once we had the tarps in place and the object was completely covered from view, that's when we finally began heading back to the pier. We ended up being escorted by what turned out to be a Navy Submarine back into the Harbor and as soon as we finally were completely moored up and back to base, I noticed what seemed to be a large convoy of a combination of Air Force and Army personnel and vehicles and large equipment just waiting for us to arrive. We were all

basically granted liberty as soon as we were completely moored up and I remember the frustration amongst the entire crew for all of the secrecy and for what turned out to be such a busy and long day that went entirely in a weird direction for us and we just weren't prepared for that. But right before we were released, we all gathered for evening quarters on the bow of the ship and we were all ordered no matter what, we were definitely NOT to speak of any of the day's incident to absolutely anybody and that we would all be briefed further in more detail in the coming days to try and get some answers to everyone. All I know is that we were told that the Air Force personnel were going to take care of the rest of the work involved as far as transporting this craft off our ship and where they ended up taking it to is anyone's guess unfortunately as I never heard anything else about that craft ever again.

As far as the 8 of us who were the only ones who were directly involved in the recovery of the object itself, I remember we were all ordered to report to MARSEC the next morning at 0900 (MARSEC was the Coast Guard shore station right by the pier our ship was moored to.) I have decided to do a separate report regarding my debriefing that following morning, but it will be a lot shorter than this one. This right here is just the exact account (to the best of my recollection at least) of my experience of being involved in the recovery of a Disk shaped metallic object or craft back in 2002.